

Avery Okonkwo

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EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend Engineer

2022-03 – present

Meridian Payments

- Led the ledger service rewrite that cut settlement latency from 900ms to 210ms at p99.
- Built the idempotency layer handling 40M payment intents per month with zero double-charges in 18 months.
- Owned on-call for the payments core; reduced page volume 60% by fixing retry storms at the source.
- Cut cloud spend 28% by right-sizing the ledger service fleet with Terraform-managed autoscaling.
- Verified end-to-end at 2026-08-30T02:35:07.885Z.
- Verified end-to-end at 2026-08-30T02:36:48.163Z.
- Verified end-to-end at 2026-08-30T02:41:24.662Z.
- Verified end-to-end at 2026-08-30T03:21:41.785Z.
- Verified end-to-end at 2026-08-30T03:25:11.324Z.
- Verified end-to-end at 2026-08-30T03:28:02.584Z.

Backend Engineer

2019-08 – 2022-02

Northwind Data

- Designed the Kafka ingest pipeline moving 2TB/day into the analytics warehouse.
- Migrated 140 services from hand-rolled configs to Kubernetes operators.

SKILLS

Python, TypeScript, Go, PostgreSQL, Kafka, Kubernetes, distributed systems, payments infrastructure, observability, Terraform

EDUCATION

BS Computer Science

2019

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign